CM3070 Project
Lecture 3

BSc and Diploma in Computer Science and Related Subjects

Synopsis for Lecture

- Reporting Project Work & Progress
- Recap – Developing the Literature Review
- Supplementary Notes on Literature Review
- Developing the Project Plan and Design
- Developing the Preliminary Project Report
- Final Things for this Session

Reporting Project Work & Progress

Assessment of the Project module (with formative feedback and peer-assessment)

Description	Coursera Week	Elements	Weightage
Project Proposal (Video)	4	• Project Concept and Related Work *(by 10 Nov 2025)*	Accepted / Not Accepted
Draft Literature Review (Report)	6	• 4-6 examples of previous work or academic literature related to the project	Formative; Peer-assessment
Project Design (Report)	8	• Overview of the project • Name which template used for the project; Domain and users of the project; Design choices, technologies and methods • Overall structure of the project; Project plan of your work including testing and evaluation	Formative; Peer-assessment
Preliminary Project Report	11	• Introduction: this will explain the project concept and motivation for the project • Literatures review: a revised version from peer review • Project Design: revised version from peer review • Feature Prototype: implementation of at least one of the most important technical features used in the project *(by 18 Dec 2025)*	10%
Project Prototype	12	• Written description of the prototype you are developing	Formative; Peer-assessment
Project Testing	14	• 3 questions for the reviewers to answer about your project	Formative; Peer-assessment
Draft Project Report	16	• Introduction: this will explain the project concept and motivation for the project • Literatures review: a revised version from peer review • Project Design: revised version from peer review • Implementation: major algorithms/techniques used, explanation of most important parts of code and a visual representation of results • Evaluation: unit testing, user studies or testing on data and give the results • Conclusion: Short summary of the project and suggest further work	Formative
Project Testing 2	18	• Revised submission of Project Testing	Formative; Peer-assessment
Draft Project Report 2	18	• Revised submission of Draft Project Report	Formative
Unseen Project Examination (2-hour written)	22/23	• Understanding of Project and How it was carried out	20%
Final Project Report and Code + Project Presentation Video	24	• Project presentation video and the final project report and code *(by 8 Mar 2026)*	65%
Check in Quizzes / Progress Logs	1-20	• Online Quizzes	5%
Total Weightage			**100%**

Recap - Literature Review (Coursera Week 6 Submission)

Developing the Literature Review (1/4)

- Coursera Week 6 requires students to submit a Literature Review for peer assessment. Before this, students are not required to submit any written content (apart from Video in Week 4).
- "2nd chapter" of the Preliminary Project Report
- This literature review can include academic papers and books. It can also include online articles and websites, but in that case, students should also explain why you consider them credible sources.
- **Students should evaluate the literature and explain how it contributes to your project, or how it demonstrates the gaps that your project intends to fill.**

Developing the Literature Review (2/4)

- Students should submit a draft literature review for your project. This should be a document covering at least 4 to 6 examples of previous work or academic literature.

- Examples of types of literature to include:
  - **Similar Projects.** Examples of projects that are similar to your own (these can be the same as those used in your proposal).
  - **Techniques and methods** that you plan to use. These could be software libraries, algorithms, or research methodologies.
  - Research **studies that show the effectiveness of the project** you intend to create (for example, if you are doing a project on educational technology, a psychological or educational study showing that the techniques you are using are effective for teaching).

Developing the Literature Review (3/4)

- This literature can include academic papers and books. It can also include online articles and websites, but in that case, you should also explain why you consider them credible sources.

- Review the work and explain how it motivates the project - not simply how good their research is.

- You should evaluate the literature and explain how it contributes to your project, or how it demonstrates the gaps that your project intends to fill.

- The literature review should also mention what ideas and analysis come out of that and how do they apply to the project you are doing.

Developing the Literature Review (4/4)

- The report should be in PDF format, up to 6 pages (minimum font size 11pt, minimum margin 2cm).
- There is a **word limit** in the summative assessment **of 2500 words** for your literature review, so it is a good idea to try to keep within this limit.
- Students may include additional pages of images and citations.
- Students should, if appropriate, use visual materials, for example, images and diagrams from the literature you are citing.
- Students might also want to include tables that compare different examples of prior work.

Marking Criteria for Literature Review

- Does it display knowledge of the area of study, previous work and academic literature? This is to assess how much you understand the domain area from the review conducted.
- Does it critically evaluate the previous work and/or academic literature? This is to assess whether you are making an argument based on the literature for the techniques or methods you are going to use for the design and development of the project?
- Does it use proper citations? This is to assess whether you are using proper citation and academic references.
- Does the report add value beyond summarising the different work coherently? This is to assess whether you have synthesise the knowledge acquired from understanding the articles.

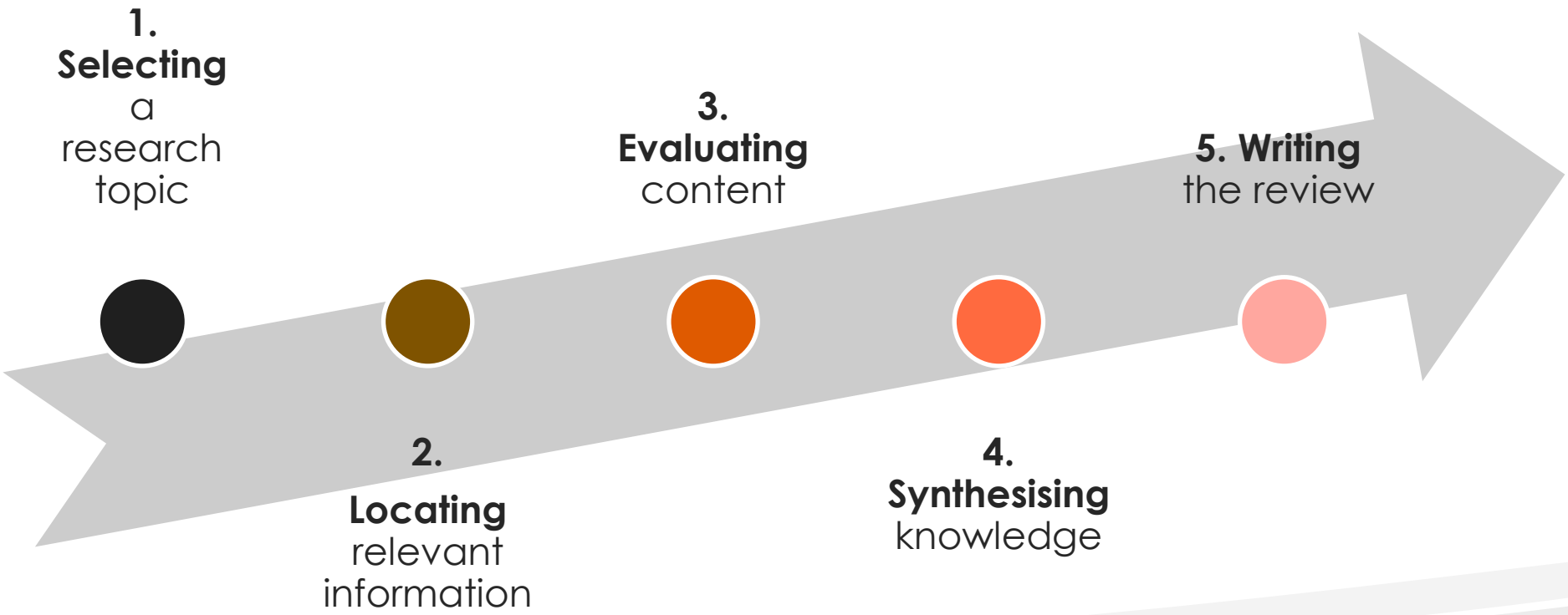
Recap - Literature Review

What comprises a Literature Review

A literature review must do these things:

- Analyses information around and related directly to the topic area you are developing
- Synthesises results into a summary of what is and is not known
- Identifies areas of controversy in the literature
- Formulates questions that need further research

Steps in Literature Review Process



Supplementary Notes on Literature Review

Adapted from "Academic Writing for Projects & Coursework"

Sarah Rauchas & Tim Taylor
Deputy Course Directors for International Programmes
Department of Computing, Goldsmiths, University of London

Literature Review

- Not there to impress examiner with how much you have read
- There to provide background for work, context and justification

Academic Writing Style (1/2)

- Involves various things, such as:
  - Good knowledge of literature
  - And knowing what literature is good
- Developing a critical view of previous work
  - Put forward your own ideas
  - And substantiate them

Academic Writing Style (2/2)

- Involves various things, such as:
  - Structuring an argument
  - Structuring a literature survey (and knowing what to leave out and what to put in)
- Knowing how to do citations and referencing properly

Citations and Plagiarism (1/3)

- Citations - Why do we do it?
  - To help the reader
  - To give credit where credit's due
  - To make clear which work is yours and which work is not
- How do we do it?
  - Different citation methods and styles, but the same basic information

Citations and Plagiarism (2/3)

- Plagiarism - What is it?
  - Where might it arise?
  - In academic writing, in programming, in exams, in assignments, etc
- How does it arise?
  - By failing to give a proper, complete citation

Citations and Plagiarism (3/3)

Unless you explicitly state otherwise:

Everything that you present in an article, report, essay, project, code, etc, will be assumed to have been written by you, about ideas that are your own

Quotes and Paraphrasing

- What goes in quotes?
  - Things you quote verbatim (word for word)
  - You also have to include page numbers here, as part of the citation
- What about paraphrasing?
  - You may paraphrase, but you have to follow or precede any paraphrase with a citation to indicate the original source

Reference List

- The reference list
  - A list of all the writings that you refer to in the main text
- What goes in the body of the text? Citations!
  - Pointers in the text to show where a quote or idea has come from
  - Allow the reader to find the matching entry in the reference list for full details

Bibliography

- How is it different to the reference list?
  - It is a list of writings that are relevant to the topic, but which are not referred to in the main text
  - Usually provided as a source of suggested further reading
  - Optional

Project Planning

Developing the Project Plan (1/4)

- One of the most useful planning aids is the Project Plan, the original version of which is submitted as part of the PPR.
- The final version of your Project Plan must be included as an Appendix in your Final Project Report. It will help the Examiners to see what you intended and may help them in marking your Report more sympathetically.
- Students should use the Project Plan as an evolving planning document, updating an electronic copy frequently in the light of results you obtain and of progress reviews.

Developing the Project Plan (2/4)

- The Project Plan should cover all aspects of work required to complete the Project, and be broken down to sub-tasks of duration generally no longer than two weeks each.
- Specify things to do in the next week, two weeks, month, and so on, so that you can measure your progress and rescope if necessary (for example, if you get behind with deadlines) at an early stage while you have time to recover.
- As time goes by, your planning (meeting deadlines) will get better and you will be able to plan the remainder of your work with more confidence.

Developing the Project Plan (3/4)

- As this is a plan it is understood that dates and activities may change.
- Include a schedule detailing all of the tasks required to complete your Project (including writing each section of the Final Report), along with key milestones.
- This can be in the form of a Gantt chart or similar planning diagram if you wish.
- Large tasks should be broken down into a number of sub-tasks, each of no more than around two weeks' duration.

Developing the Project Plan (4/4)

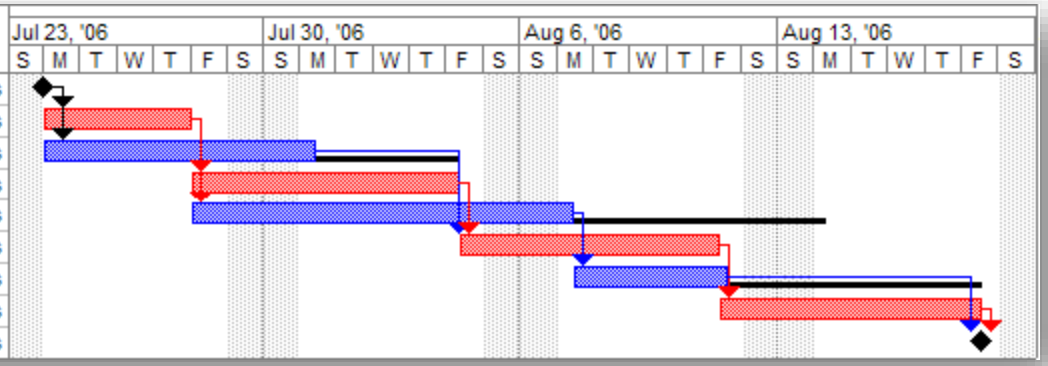
- In the main text of the Report, you can include a table of **activities detailing the development work** as well as the **production schedule for writing the PPR and final report**.

S/N	Task	Estimated Start Date	Estimated End Date	Actual Start Date	Actual End Date	Dependency

- Students can refer the Gantt chart as an appendix.
- The Project Plan will be submitted as part of the Project Design document and also in the PPR.

Example of Gantt Chart

ID	Task Name	Predecessors	Duration
1	Start		0 days
2	a	1	4 days
3	b	1	5.33 days
4	c	2	5.17 days
5	d	2	6.33 days
6	e	3,4	5.17 days
7	f	5	4.5 days
8	g	6	5.17 days
9	Finish	7,8	0 days



Project Design (Coursera Week 8 Submission)

Developing the Project Design Report (1/4)

- By Coursera Week 8, students are required to submit a project design.
- "3rd chapter" of the Preliminary Project Report
- In this assignment, students will submit a design for this project and include:
  - An overview of the project
  - The idea for the project
  - Name which template you have used for the project (markers need to cross-refer to the templates)
  - Explain the domain and users of the project. Who is the project for? What is the domain of the project (e.g. music game, history education, therapy for phobias, narrative films)?

Developing the Project Design Report (2/4)

- In this assignment, students will submit a design for this project. It should include: (cont'd)
  - Justify your design choices based on the needs of users/the requirements of the domain.
  - The overall structure of the project (this could be the architecture of a software project, the story of a VR project, the visual interface of a mobile app or the research question and methods of a data science project)
  - Identification of the important technologies and methods you will be using in the project. State how you intend to achieve the aims and objectives, and why you intend to do it this way.

Developing the Project Design Report (3/4)

- In this assignment, students will submit a design for this project. It should include: (cont'd)
  - A plan of your work. This should include the major tasks and when you will do them laid out visually (for example in a Gantt chart). Include a schedule detailing all of the tasks required to complete your Project (including writing each section of the Final Report), along with key milestones. This can be in the form of a Gantt chart or similar planning diagram if you wish. Large tasks should be broken down into a number of sub-tasks, each of no more than around two weeks' duration.
  - A plan for how you will test and evaluate your project. This should include the techniques to evaluate it, and the key aims to evaluate it against.

Developing the Project Design Report (4/4)

- The Project Design report should take:
  - The form of a PDF document of maximum 2000 words.
- Students can attach additional pages of images or references that do not contribute to the word count.

Marking Criteria for Project Design Report

- The Project Design Report will be marked according to the following criteria:
  - Is the design of the project clear and of high quality?
  - Is the project concept justified based on the domain and users?
  - Is the workplan explained in details?
  - Is the workplan feasible (timeline and activities)?
  - Is the evaluation strategy appropriate to the aims of the project?
  - Is the workplan explained in enough detail?

Preliminary Project Report (Coursera Week 10 Submission)

Developing the Preliminary Project Report (1/6)

- In Coursera Week 10, students are required to submit a Preliminary Project Report (PPR) which will be 10% of their final grade. In this staff graded assignment, students will submit a preliminary draft of some aspects of the final project report.
- The report will consist of at least 4 chapters (excluding Title Page, Appendices and References). In addition to the word limits listed, students can have additional pages of images and references.
- The per-chapter maximums are strict, as is the overall word count. Note that the total word count of the four chapters is 6000. This is not an error but it allows flexibility in the length of each chapter, and let you balance the document to some extent.
- Students can return to the 3 peer reviews for instructions on the first three chapters of this submission.

Developing the Preliminary Project Report (2/6)

Title page	Giving the title, student name, date, degree title, supervisor name, name of local institution attended (or write 'Self-study'), University of London International Programmes student registration number
Introduction*	This will explain the project concept and motivation for the project (this chapter can be elaborated from your project proposal previously submitted). This must also state the idea for the project and which project template you are using (max 1000 words)

Developing the Preliminary Project Report (3/6)

Literature Review*	This is a revised version of the document that students previously had submitted for the second peer review (max 2500 words).
Project Design*	This is a revised version of the document that students previously had submitted for the third peer review (max 2000 words).

Developing the Preliminary Project Report (4/6)

Feature Prototype*	This is a new element of the submission, details below (max 1500 words). The feature prototype should be an implementation of at least one of the most important technical features in the project to show it is feasible. Examples of key features include: • Key Algorithm with dummy data (in ML and AI projects) • Main interaction technique (in UI projects) • Main game mechanic (in 3D and game development projects). It should work as designed, but it is OK at this stage if developing the prototype shows that the feature is not as effective as expected.

Developing the Preliminary Project Report (5/6)

Feature Prototype*	Students should describe the prototype as a chapter of the PPR, together with an evaluation of how well you think the prototype works (include explaining the source code if appropriate)and how you would improve it. Students should also submit a **~3 minute video** demonstrating it. Refer to Coursera Week 9 for examples of videos. Make sure the feature prototype considered the following areas: • Is the feature prototype of high quality? • Is the feature prototype technically challenging? • Does the report successfully evaluate the feature prototype show suitable improvements if appropriate?

Developing the Preliminary Project Report (6/6)

PPR template for students

Appendices	Appendices should be cross-referenced in the relevant section of the main text. No Appendix should be present unless cross-referenced from the main text.
References	Giving full publication details of all literature referred to in the PPR. For details, please refer to: https://onlinelibrary.london.ac.uk/support/information-skills/organising-and-citing-your-references/citing-references. This list will generally be much shorter than that for the (later and much larger) Final Project Report.

Referencing (1/2)

- An essential part of academic writing is acknowledging the sources that you have consulted. This is called citing references.
- You need to reference every time you refer to someone else's work, this does not just include direct quotations but also when you paraphrase or summarise.
- Each referencing style will require you to provide similar information such as the author, the year the item was published, the page number if there is a quotation, the title of the book or journal etc.

Referencing (2/2)

- There are a variety of different referencing styles however you will usually be required to:
  - Indicate in the body of the text or in a footnote when you are referring to a source.
  - Provide a Bibliography of the sources that you referred to at the end of your work.
- Your references may not only refer to books and journal articles, you may also need to include information from websites, newspapers and visual information such as films or photographs.
- For details, please refer to: https://onlinelibrary.london.ac.uk/support/information-skills/organising-and-citing-your-references/citing-references.

How to avoid plagiarism (1/4)

- Plagiarism is serious academic misconduct, involving:
  - submitting a piece of coursework which contains unacknowledged material from books or other sources;
  - copying any part of the work of fellow students;
  - reproducing any part of a piece of coursework completed in previous years without acknowledgment.

- Please note that plagiarism constitutes an examination offence. If the University confirms a piece of coursework to be plagiarised:
  - a mark of zero (0) will be given for the coursework concerned
  - you will be formally reprimanded.

Reference Source (16 Mar 2024): https://computing.elearning.london.ac.uk/mod/page/view.php?id=5176

How to avoid plagiarism (2/4)

- DO use Turnitin to check your work before submitting your assignments.

- Repeated offences of plagiarism will attract greater penalties. The University may decide:
  - that there should be a mark of zero for the course concerned
  - that there should be a mark of zero for all of the courses taken in the year concerned
  - that you be excluded from any or all future examinations of the University.

Reference Source (16 Mar 2024): https://computing.elearning.london.ac.uk/mod/page/view.php?id=5176

How to avoid plagiarism (3/4)

- A reminder to all students:
  - it is not sufficient to provide a list of sources as this does not distinguish your work from the source material. No credit will be given as a plagiarism offence has been committed since the copied material has not been identified.
  - any quoted material (that is, taken verbatim or word for word) must be clearly identified: quotation marks should be used (along with italics and indentation for clarity) and author surname, date of publication and page number(s) cited. You should avoid quoting at length from any source, as this does not demonstrate your understanding.

Reference Source (16 Mar 2024): https://computing.elearning.london.ac.uk/mod/page/view.php?id=5176

How to avoid plagiarism (4/4)

- A reminder to all students: (cont'd)
  - if material is paraphrased (that is, re-worded) the extent of the paraphrase must be clear, and author surname and date of publication cited. It is not acceptable to retain significant amounts of the original wording.
  - full details of all sources identified in the text should be included in a separate alphabetical referencing list at the end of the assignment. See the Harvard Referencing Guide for further details.
  - Graphical material should also be acknowledged.

Reference Source (16 Mar 2024): https://computing.elearning.london.ac.uk/mod/page/view.php?id=5176

Marking Criteria for Preliminary Project Report (1/2)

- The PPR will be marked according to the following criteria:
  - Does the report display knowledge of the area of study, previous work and academic literature?
  - Does the report critically evaluate the previous work and/or academic literature?
  - Does the report use proper citation?
  - Is the design of the project clear and of high quality?
  - Is the project concept justified based on the domain and users?
  - Is the workplan explained in enough detail?

Marking Criteria for Preliminary Project Report (2/2)

- The PPR will be marked according to the following criteria: (cont'd)
  - Is the workplan feasible?
  - Is the evaluation strategy appropriate to the aims of the project?
  - Is the feature prototype of high quality?
  - Is the feature prototype technically challenging?
  - Does the report successfully evaluate the feature prototype and show suitable improvements if appropriate?

Final Things for this Session

Engage, Engage, Engage

It is important to keep in constant contact with your supervisor – update your progress and get your supervisor to review the reports.

See you at next session !